



LET'S EXPLORE

Soil around us

Look at the soil near your school or home.

Does all soil look and feel the same?

Can plants grow equally well in every type of soil?

Grab a magnifying glass and let's investigate!



What is soil?

Soil is a mixture of five amazing things:



ZOOM IN

Organic matter

Comes from once-living things — fallen leaves, plants, and animals that break down over time.



Leaves

Roots

Bugs

Microbes

SOIL TYPE · 1

Sandy soil

- Large particles
- Feels rough to the touch
- Big spaces between particles
- Drains water quickly
- Holds less water



SOIL TYPE · 2

Clay soil

- Very small particles
- Feels smooth or sticky when wet
- Holds a lot of water
- Drains water slowly
- Can become hard when dry



Silt soil

- Small particles, finer than sand
- Feels smooth like flour
- Holds more water than sandy soil
- Easier to work with than clay



SOIL TYPE · 4 · THE BEST!

Loam soil

- A mixture of sand, silt, and clay
- Contains mixed particle sizes
- Holds water AND allows drainage
- Suitable for many plants



Comparing soil types

Soil	Particle size	Texture	Water-holding
Sandy	Large	Rough	Low
Silt	Small	Smooth	Moderate
Clay	Very small	Sticky when wet	High
Loam	Mixed	Soft & crumbly	Moderate-High

WHY IT MATTERS

How soil helps plants grow

Soil gives plants everything they need:

Water

Nutrients

Air

Root support

Different soils hold water and air differently — that changes how well plants grow!



ACTIVITY 1

Which soil am I?

Read each clue. Can you guess the soil type?

1

I feel rough and let water pass through quickly.

2

I'm sticky when wet and I hold a lot of water.

3

I have fine, smooth particles.

4

I'm a mixture of sand, silt, and clay — great for plants!

ACTIVITY 2

Soil investigators

Examine each sample and record what you find!

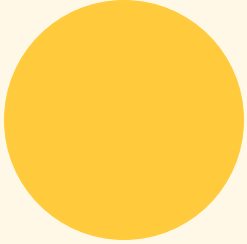
1 What does the texture feel like?

2 How big are the particles?

3 How much water does it hold?

4 Which plants would grow best?



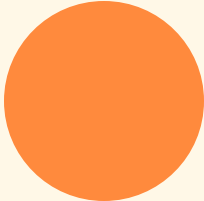


TIME TO SHINE

Let's check what you've learned!



Choose the best answer for each question.



5 questions

Questions 1 – 3

1

Which of these is NOT a component of soil?

A. Rock fragments

B. Water

C. Air

D. Plastic bottles

2

Which soil has large particles and drains water quickly?

A. Clay

B. Sandy

C. Silt

D. Loam

3

Which soil has very small particles and can hold a lot of water?

A. Clay

B. Sandy

C. Silt

D. Loam

Questions 4 – 5

1 Which soil is a mixture of sand, silt, and clay?

A. Sandy

B. Silt

C. Loam

D. Clay

2 Why can different types of soil affect plant growth?

A. Different properties & water-holding abilities

B. All soils are the same

C. Because of colour only

D. Plants pick their soil

ANSWER KEY

How did you do?

Q1

D

Plastic bottles

Q2

B

Sandy

Q3

A

Clay

Q4

C

Loam

Q5

A

Different properties

Great job! Keep exploring soil and plants. 🌱



THANK YOU!